

Data Fence v. Bending Spoons S.p.A.

Server-assisted inbound-call control and robocall filtering using caller data, negative characteristics, and an interactive challenge-response step.

Independent preliminary research based on public information.

FILED	FORUM	DOCKET	MATTER
2026-08-21	E.D. Tex.	2:26-cv-00726	Patent Infringement

Prepared 2026-08-25. No attorney or expert contacted. Availability, interest, compensation, and conflicts not checked.

Public filing, likely recipient, and technical frame

CAPTION	Data Fence LLC v. Bending Spoons S.p.A.
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FORUM / DOCKET	E.D. Tex. / 2:26-cv-00726
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FILED / TYPE	2026-08-21 / patent infringement
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PUBLIC DOCKET	Open docket
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VERIFIED PUBLIC RECORD

Data Fence LLC v. Bending Spoons S.p.A., No. 2:26-cv-00726, filed 2026-08-21 in E.D. Tex..

LIKELY RESEARCH PURCHASER

Isaac Phillip Rabicoff - Rabicoff Law LLC; named matter counsel. The public docket identifies Rabicoff as plaintiff counsel, complaint filer, and filer of the opening papers. Selecting him as likely purchaser is an analytical inference from that role.

isaac@rabilaw.com - publicly listed on the [official firm biography](#); not inferred.

TECHNICAL FRAME

Server-assisted inbound-call control and robocall filtering using caller data, negative characteristics, and an interactive challenge-response step.

Secondary-source limitation: This is a preliminary technical frame based on public sources. Filed pleadings, claim charts, discovery, source code, product versions, and admissible evidence must control. [Open public synopsis](#)

Questions likely to require expert input

This issue map is a research plan, not a legal conclusion. The filed complaint, patent exhibits, intrinsic record, and discovery must control.

01 Claim mapping and accused operation

Claim mapping and accused operation: How Bending Spoons-controlled call-filtering services obtain caller data, score negative characteristics, issue interactive challenges, and cause network or device call-control decisions.

Potential evidence: Pleadings and claim charts; source code or engineering records; product and version documentation; standards and prior art; reproducible testing; and fact or technical testimony as applicable.

02 Technical meaning and ordinary skill

Technical meaning and ordinary skill: what would a person of ordinary skill have understood the asserted computing, media, networking, or telephony terms to mean at the relevant priority dates?

Potential evidence: Pleadings and claim charts; source code or engineering records; product and version documentation; standards and prior art; reproducible testing; and fact or technical testimony as applicable.

03 Architecture and causation

Architecture and causation: which device, client, server, network element, or code module performs each claimed step, in what order, and under what configurations?

Potential evidence: Pleadings and claim charts; source code or engineering records; product and version documentation; standards and prior art; reproducible testing; and fact or technical testimony as applicable.

04 Versioning and proof

Versioning and proof: which source-code branches, protocol traces, media samples, configuration records, test captures, and product versions are needed for reproducible analysis?

Potential evidence: Pleadings and claim charts; source code or engineering records; product and version documentation; standards and prior art; reproducible testing; and fact or technical testimony as applicable.

Questions likely to require expert input

05 Validity and technical contribution

Validity and technical contribution: what dated publications, standards, patents, products, and implementations disclose the claimed elements, and what technical value is attributable to the claimed combination rather than conventional components?

Potential evidence: Pleadings and claim charts; source code or engineering records; product and version documentation; standards and prior art; reproducible testing; and fact or technical testimony as applicable.

Candidates 1-2 for further diligence

Ranked for preliminary research priority based on subject-matter fit, relevant public work, testimony, and visible diligence burden. This is not a retention recommendation.

01 Henning Schulzrinne

Julian Clarence Levi Professor of Computer Science and Professor of Electrical Engineering, Columbia University

TECHNICAL FIT

Internet telephony, RTP, RTSP, SIP, multimedia protocols, signaling, quality of service, and network measurement. For Data Fence LLC v. Bending Spoons S.p.A., the fit is specifically server-assisted inbound-call control, caller reputation data, negative characteristics, challenge-response, and robocall filtering.

RELEVANT WORK

Co-developed RTP, RTSP, and SIP, protocols used across Internet telephony and multimedia applications. Published more than 250 papers and more than 70 Internet RFCs; formerly FCC CTO and technology advisor.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific public expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial-testimony record for Henning Schulzrinne was located in a bounded public-web search. This is not proof that the candidate has never served in litigation; PACER, paid expert databases, retention records, and conflict systems were not searched.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Protocol and architecture fit is exceptional, but product-specific source-code, codec, and mobile UI analysis may require complementary specialists. Matter-specific diligence should also test independence from the parties, patents, accused products, and counsel; no conflict clearance has been performed.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | hgs@cs.columbia.edu | [public email source](#)

02 Patrick Traynor

John and Mary Lou Dasburg Preeminent Chair and Professor, University of Florida

TECHNICAL FIT

Telecommunications security, mobile systems, cellular networks, caller-ID scams, and applied cryptography. For Data Fence LLC v. Bending Spoons S.p.A., the fit is specifically server-assisted inbound-call control, caller reputation data, negative characteristics, challenge-response, and robocall filtering.

RELEVANT WORK

Research uncovered cellular-network vulnerabilities and developed approaches to detect and combat caller-ID scams. Leads research on telecommunications infrastructure and mobile-device security.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific public expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial-testimony record for Patrick Traynor was located in a bounded public-web search. This is not proof that the candidate has never served in litigation; PACER, paid expert databases, retention records, and conflict systems were not searched.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Security and abuse-detection focus may not cover all PBX policy-engine, switch, and patent-priority questions; pairing with a signaling architect is advisable. Matter-specific diligence should also test independence from the parties, patents, accused products, and counsel; no conflict clearance has been performed.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | traynor@cise.ufl.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 3-4 for further diligence

03 Mustaque Ahamad

SCP Interim Chair and USG Regents Entrepreneur Professor, Georgia Tech

TECHNICAL FIT

Security of converged communication networks, identity and access management, distributed systems, and fraud detection. For Data Fence LLC v. Bending Spoons S.p.A., the fit is specifically server-assisted inbound-call control, caller reputation data, negative characteristics, challenge-response, and robocall filtering.

RELEVANT WORK

Former director of the Georgia Tech Information Security Center; research includes converged-network security and identity management. Co-founded Pindrop Security and serves as chief scientist, connecting academic work to voice-fraud systems.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific public expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial-testimony record for Mustaque Ahamad was located in a bounded public-web search. This is not proof that the candidate has never served in litigation; PACER, paid expert databases, retention records, and conflict systems were not searched.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Pindrop affiliation may create conflicts in call-authentication matters; not principally a telephony-switch implementation or codec specialist. Matter-specific diligence should also test independence from the parties, patents, accused products, and counsel; no conflict clearance has been performed.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | mustaque.ahamad@cc.gatech.edu | [public email source](#)

04 Geoffrey M. Voelker

Professor of Computer Science & Engineering, UC San Diego

TECHNICAL FIT

Experimental computer systems, networking, security, mobile/wireless systems, cybercrime, and network measurement. For Data Fence LLC v. Bending Spoons S.p.A., the fit is specifically server-assisted inbound-call control, caller reputation data, negative characteristics, challenge-response, and robocall filtering.

RELEVANT WORK

Runs empirical work spanning wireless systems, cybercrime, cloud storage, networking, and security. Research emphasizes design, implementation, measurement, and evaluation of deployed systems.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific public expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial-testimony record for Geoffrey M. Voelker was located in a bounded public-web search. This is not proof that the candidate has never served in litigation; PACER, paid expert databases, retention records, and conflict systems were not searched.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Broad empirical-systems fit rather than narrow expertise in SIP signaling, call-switch policy engines, or voice identity mapping. Matter-specific diligence should also test independence from the parties, patents, accused products, and counsel; no conflict clearance has been performed.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | voelker@ucsd.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 5-6 for further diligence

05 Stefan Savage

Professor of Computer Science & Engineering, UC San Diego

TECHNICAL FIT

Network security, cybercrime, spam and abuse ecosystems, measurement, distributed systems, and mobile/wireless security. For Data Fence LLC v. Bending Spoons S.p.A., the fit is specifically server-assisted inbound-call control, caller reputation data, negative characteristics, challenge-response, and robocall filtering.

RELEVANT WORK

Publishes on spam, scam conversion, text-message spoofing, cybercrime, and empirical network measurement. Directs or co-directs major UCSD network-systems and Internet-defense research centers.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific public expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial-testimony record for Stefan Savage was located in a bounded public-web search. This is not proof that the candidate has never served in litigation; PACER, paid expert databases, retention records, and conflict systems were not searched.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Strong abuse-ecosystem and measurement expert but less directly focused on PBX hardware, call-switch state machines, or standards-essential telephony signaling. Matter-specific diligence should also test independence from the parties, patents, accused products, and counsel; no conflict clearance has been performed.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | savage@cs.ucsd.edu | [public email source](#)

06 Nick Feamster

Neubauer Professor of Computer Science and Faculty Director of Research, Data Science Institute, University of Chicago

TECHNICAL FIT

Internet measurement, video technologies, software-defined networking, privacy, and deployed network systems. For Data Fence LLC v. Bending Spoons S.p.A., the fit is specifically server-assisted inbound-call control, caller reputation data, negative characteristics, challenge-response, and robocall filtering.

RELEVANT WORK

Built early live-television-over-Internet systems and researches network performance and security. His official homepage states experience as an expert witness in software patent, copyright, trade-secret, privacy, and other technology litigation, including federal trial testimony.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Official University of Chicago homepage states that he serves as an expert witness in technology litigation and has federal trial-testimony experience in software patent, copyright, trade-secret, privacy, and related matters.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Broad systems expert rather than a narrow specialist in a particular codec, Apple framework, or telephony switch; active expert practice requires careful conflicts diligence. Matter-specific diligence should also test independence from the parties, patents, accused products, and counsel; no conflict clearance has been performed.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | feamster@uchicago.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 7-8 for further diligence

07 David Choffnes

Professor, Khoury College of Computer Sciences, Northeastern University

TECHNICAL FIT

Internet-scale measurement, mobile and IoT systems, network reliability, privacy, security, and protocol behavior. For Data Fence LLC v. Bending Spoons S.p.A., the fit is specifically server-assisted inbound-call control, caller reputation data, negative characteristics, challenge-response, and robocall filtering.

RELEVANT WORK

Published more than 100 peer-reviewed works on Internet systems, mobile/IoT security, and measurement. Builds and evaluates systems for understanding deployed network behavior and reliability.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific public expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial-testimony record for David Choffnes was located in a bounded public-web search. This is not proof that the candidate has never served in litigation; PACER, paid expert databases, retention records, and conflict systems were not searched.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Not principally a telephony signaling or PBX expert; best used for network measurement, mobile-app behavior, and reproducible testing. Matter-specific diligence should also test independence from the parties, patents, accused products, and counsel; no conflict clearance has been performed.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | choffnes@ccs.neu.edu | [public email source](#)

08 A. Selcuk Uluagac

Eminent Scholar Chaired Professor, Florida International University

TECHNICAL FIT

Cybersecurity and privacy of IoT, cyber-physical systems, mobile/wireless systems, malware, and digital forensics. For Data Fence LLC v. Bending Spoons S.p.A., the fit is specifically server-assisted inbound-call control, caller reputation data, negative characteristics, challenge-response, and robocall filtering.

RELEVANT WORK

Leads FIU's Cyber-Physical Systems Security Lab and has more than ten patents. Published extensively in NDSS, USENIX Security, IEEE TIFS, and related applied-security venues.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific public expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial-testimony record for A. Selcuk Uluagac was located in a bounded public-web search. This is not proof that the candidate has never served in litigation; PACER, paid expert databases, retention records, and conflict systems were not searched.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Applied security breadth is stronger than direct PBX, SIP-proxy, or voice-policy-engine specialization. Matter-specific diligence should also test independence from the parties, patents, accused products, and counsel; no conflict clearance has been performed.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | suluagac@fiu.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 9-10 for further diligence

09 Vijay Sivaraman

Professor of Electrical Engineering and Telecommunications, UNSW Sydney

TECHNICAL FIT

Video-streaming delivery, network performance, software-defined networking, gaming traffic, and IoT systems. For Data Fence LLC v. Bending Spoons S.p.A., the fit is specifically server-assisted inbound-call control, caller reputation data, negative characteristics, challenge-response, and robocall filtering.

RELEVANT WORK

UNSW describes his work on architectures and algorithms for video streaming and gaming. Led an ARC project on interactive scalable media over software-defined networks and publishes network-measurement studies of cloud gaming.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific public expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial-testimony record for Vijay Sivaraman was located in a bounded public-web search. This is not proof that the candidate has never served in litigation; PACER, paid expert databases, retention records, and conflict systems were not searched.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Primarily a network-architecture expert; would need a codec or application specialist for elementary-stream and media-composition questions. Matter-specific diligence should also test independence from the parties, patents, accused products, and counsel; no conflict clearance has been performed.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | vijay@unsw.edu.au | [public email source](#)

10 Steven M. Bellovin

Percy K. and Vida L. W. Hudson Professor Emeritus of Computer Science, Columbia University; Senior Affiliate Scholar, Georgetown Institute for Technology Law & Policy

TECHNICAL FIT

Network security, telecommunications policy, cryptography, Internet architecture, and technology-law interfaces. For Data Fence LLC v. Bending Spoons S.p.A., the fit is specifically server-assisted inbound-call control, caller reputation data, negative characteristics, challenge-response, and robocall filtering.

RELEVANT WORK

Former FTC Chief Technologist and longtime AT&T Bell Labs/AT&T Labs researcher. Research and public service span network security, telecommunications, surveillance, privacy, and Internet policy.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific public expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial-testimony record for Steven M. Bellovin was located in a bounded public-web search. This is not proof that the candidate has never served in litigation; PACER, paid expert databases, retention records, and conflict systems were not searched.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Retired from teaching and advising; fit is strongest for security architecture and historical context, not product teardown or current PBX implementation. Matter-specific diligence should also test independence from the parties, patents, accused products, and counsel; no conflict clearance has been performed.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | smb@cs.columbia.edu | [public email source](#)

Preliminary candidates; no conflicts or availability determination

- Run party, affiliate, counsel, inventor, funder, and technology conflicts.
- Confirm testimony history, exclusions, compensation, publications, patents, and deposition performance.
- Investigate licensing, grants, consulting, commercial interests, and prior technical positions.
- Confirm role fit, availability, and interest only after counsel authorizes outreach.

ONGOING MATTER-SPECIFIC RESEARCH

Flint Witness Research works in the post-filing window, turning pleadings and public technical records into issue maps, researched candidate slates, and diligence starting points as the case develops.

[Schedule a 15-minute conversation](#)

CORE SOURCES

Public docket: <https://dockets.justia.com/docket/texas/txedce/2%3A2026cv00726/248603>

Official attorney biography and email: <https://ai-lab.exparte.com/attorney/1221181/isaac-rabicoff>

Public technical context source: <https://ai-lab.exparte.com/case/dct/txed/2%3A26-cv-00726/doc/analysis/1>

LIMITATIONS

This is a preliminary technical frame based on public sources. Filed pleadings, claim charts, discovery, source code, product versions, and admissible evidence must control.

No attorney or expert was contacted. Availability, interest, compensation, and conflicts were not checked.